Ira Akbar

Product Designer

+91 9828276184 | helloiraakbar@gmail.com | LinkedIn

I'm a product designer with 5+ years of experience in designing digital products, from discovery to launch. Most recently, I led product and design for a multilingual Voice AI platform, simplifying complex outreach workflows for businesses and designing conversations across Indian languages and literacy levels.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lead Product Designer | Hunar.ai

Bengaluru | March 2024 - Present | Series A

- Led a team of designers and video editors, working closely with front-end developers, and owned roadmap and end-to-end design for Hunar Voice as monthly calls grew from 3.1M to 11M (Mar–Sep 2026).
- Designed Hunar Voice end to end as it grew from an API-only tool into a self-serve platform, covering agent creation, campaign management, self sign-up, and multi-org workspaces. Cut time to a client's first campaign from months to a few days.
- Built Hunar's design system and visual identity from scratch across Hunar Voice and Hunar Connect, with moments of intentional delight throughout the product.
- Defined Hunar's positioning, tone, and narrative from user research and first-hand client work, running demos and customer success myself, and carried it into fundraising decks, sales collateral, and product launch comms.
- Conversational Design - Shaped adaptive multilingual conversations using contextual probing and branching, and used call reviews to reduce hallucinations and mid-call drop-offs.
- As a forward deployed designer for Zepto and Aditya Birla Capital, redesigned long calls into multi-stage workflows and shipped them myself with Claude Code, GCP, and n8n. Win-back flows converted 3% of leads marked not engaged.
- Built internal prompt makers with Claude and ChatGPT, cutting agent prompt prep for demos and go-lives from 1 to 2 days to a few hours. The approach now informs an in-product context layer and prompt rewriter in development.
- Defined Hunar Connect CRM workflows for AI assessments, CV matching, candidate recommendations, and walk-in interviews, extending Material Design for its interface; used by 30+ active clients.
- Designed and tested Hunar Disha, a career assistant, through a concierge MVP with 40 pilot users and 8 candidates placed, then built and shipped a live CV tailoring tool with Lovable and ChatGPT before the project was paused.

Consultant UX Designer | Kotak Securities

Mumbai (Remote) | September 2023 - February 2024

- Initiated Kotak Neo's first AI feature, a chat-based assistant for stock and mutual fund investing, defining the concept and designing the proof of concept that informed its beta launch.
- Used scroll and click data to find features users were missing on StockCase and SipIt, restructuring information hierarchy and A/B testing copy to improve discovery.

Product & Design | Quash

Bengaluru | June 2023 - January 2024 | Founding Team - Independent collaboration

- Designed the SDK integration experience and dashboard for a mobile app testing platform, taking it from concept to beta with a seven-member team.
- Led product discovery and turned customer feedback into product improvements, supporting eight client onboardings and adoption by Ola, Rebel Foods and BetterHalf.

Product Designer | Parallel HQ

Bengaluru | September 2021 - June 2023

Judges Intelligent Virtual Assistant (Jiva) Case Study

Researched judicial workflows and designed an MVP for an AI assistant that helps judges search, ask questions, and reference case documents during hearings.

Bangalore Pulse Airport App Case Study

Contributed to discovery and experience design for Bengaluru International Airport's loyalty app, using modular design and server-driven UI for personalised experiences.

Apperture Product Analytics Tool Case Study

Designed a 0 to 1 analytics platform, defining its visual language and core experiences for query building, data exploration, and an embedded AI assistant.

UX Researcher | Kritsnam Technologies

Hyderabad (Remote) | July - August 2021

Conducted competitor analysis, ecosystem mapping, interviews, and surveys for the Dhara B2B SaaS dashboard, identifying target user groups and informing product recommendations.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Design (2017-2021)

National Institute of Fashion Technology, Gandhinagar (9.0 CGPA)
Awarded Best Academic Performance and the title of Most Meritorious Student

SKILLS

Product & Design
Discovery, roadmapping, user research, information architecture, interaction design, prototyping, design systems

Conversational AI
Multilingual conversation design, prompt design and evaluation, call-quality analysis

Technical Implementation
AI-assisted prototyping, API integrations, workflow automation

Product Marketing & Communication
Product positioning, sales pitches, public speaking, workshop facilitation

TOOLS

Figma | Claude Code | Google Cloud Platform | n8n | Framer | Mixpanel | Excel | Adobe Creative Suite | Storybook | Grafana | Metabase

SPEAKING & WORKSHOPS

The India AI Impact Summit 2026

Speaker | Using Conversational AI to Spot Attrition Signals | Watch Talk

EkStep Voice AI Conference

Speaker | From App Drop-offs to Conversational Onboarding | Watch Talk

Scaler School of Technology

Guest Lecturer | Designing with Empathy

NIFT, Gandhinagar

Guest Lecturer | Storytelling in Case Studies; Basics of UX Design

DESIGN AWARDS

Titan Design Award

- 2020, Habit-forming smart wearable ring
- 2019, Posture-correcting smart jewellery